

MAX MATTHEWS

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SUMMARY

Senior full-stack software engineer with 10+ years shipping production software across enterprise, government, and startup environments, including conversational AI and developer education. Deep React, TypeScript, and Node.js foundation with hands-on experience integrating LLM features and leveraging AI coding tools to accelerate delivery. Proven leader of cross-functional teams and mentor of next-generation developers.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Vailent | Full Stack Engineer *November 2025 - May 2026*

- Built core features for Catalog, Vailent's AI-powered product data platform for chemical materials companies.
- Leveraged Claude Code at every stage of the SDLC, transforming traditional workflows into an AI Development Lifecycle (AIDLC) spanning PM requirements intake, architecture, implementation, code review, and DevOps.
- Partnered with an AI engineer to design and build a Neo4j knowledge graph powering material equivalence lookups, application-based product matching, and semantic discovery across the catalog.

tuzag, inc. *July 2016 - October 2025*

Chief Technology Officer *February 2021 - October 2025*

- Integrated third-party LLMs (OpenAI, Gemini) to build an AI-powered bot for dynamic content generation; leveraged a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) knowledge base with grounding metadata to ensure context-aware and accurate multiturn responses.
- Led mobile development and architected an integrated remote patient monitoring system for the Veterans Administration (Life365 subcontract), delivering a scalable, secure digital health solution.
- Balanced hands-on engineering with leadership, building and scaling two software teams from zero through hiring, mentorship, and career growth paths.

Lead Developer *July 2016 - February 2021*

- Designed and developed scalable full-stack JavaScript solutions (Node.js, Express, React, React Native, MySQL, Google Cloud Platform) for multi-channel conversational applications across mobile, web, email, and voice.
- Transformed large datasets into actionable insights for personalized, automated communication flows.

Hack Upstate - Careers in Code *April 2019 - October 2024*

Dean of Students & Lead Instructor *February 2022 - October 2024*

- Led software education program operations, including nightly live classes, 1:1 mentoring, and alumni network building.
- Modernized the full-stack curriculum and LMS by incorporating practical applications of AI tools and APIs, preparing students for emerging industry trends.
- Built student pipelines into tech careers through code reviews, project-based learning, and career mentorship.

Instructor *April 2019 - February 2022*

- Taught full-stack JavaScript fundamentals to bootcamp students part-time.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Proficient: TypeScript, React, React Native, Node.js, TanStack, Tailwind, Supabase, PostgreSQL, Vite, Neo4j, Claude Code, OpenAI APIs, Gemini APIs, RAG, Docker, Git, Bash

Previously: Meteor, Mongo, MySQL, Google Cloud Platform, Python, PHP, WordPress, Figma, Government Contracting

EDUCATION

Syracuse University, School of Information Studies *2012 - 2015*

Completed coursework toward Bachelor of Science, Information Management & Technology

Minor: Information Technology, Design, & Startups | Activities: NEXIS Research Lab, BeIT